OVERALL IMPACT OF NON-ACADEMIC STRIKE ON STUDENTS ACROSS ALL TWO YEARS IN THE FACULTY OF SCIENCE

STAT 22632 – Survey Methods and Sampling Techniques

Department of Statistics & Computer Science

University of Kelaniya

Academic Year 2023/2024

By Group Number 09

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Declaration

Declaration We do hereby declare that the work reported in this report which titled as "**Overall impact of non-academic strike on students across all two years in the faculty of science**" is originally prepared by us, **Group Number 09** in the purpose of partial fulfilment of requirement of the Bachelor of Science Degree, Department of Statistics & Computer Science, Faculty of Science, University of Kelaniya, Sri Lanka and not for any other academic purposes. No part of this report has been submitted earlier or concurrently for the same or any other degree.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

Universities depend on both academic and non-academic staff to run smoothly. Non-academic staff play an important role in supporting teaching activities, maintaining facilities, and providing essential administrative services. When non-academic staff go on strike, normal university functions are disrupted.

At the end of April 2024, a non-academic staff strike occurred at the University of Kelaniya and lasted for approximately 12–13 weeks. During this period, students in the Faculty of Science faced interruptions to lectures, laboratory sessions, access to libraries, and other academic services. Many activities were shifted to online platforms, which created new academic and personal challenges for students.

This study focuses on understanding how this strike affected first-year and second-year undergraduate students in the Faculty of Science, both academically and mentally.

1.2 Objectives of the Study

The main objectives of this study are:

- To identify which academic year (first-year or second-year) was most affected by the 2024 non-academic staff strike.
- To examine the academic impact of the strike on students in the Faculty of Science.
- To analyze the psychological and emotional effects of the strike on students.
- To assess students' experiences with online learning during the strike period.
- To provide suggestions to reduce the negative impact of similar strikes in the future.
- To analyze the positive outcomes of the non-academic staff strike, if any, based on students' responses, such as adaptability to online learning and self-study skills.

2. Methodology

2.1 Questionnaire Design

The questionnaire was designed to assess the **overall impact of the non-academic staff strike** on students. It consisted of structured questions divided into the following sections:

- Demographic Data
- Technical and infrastructure issues
- Academic and learning effectiveness
- Psychological impact and student well-being
- Post-strike academic recovery

The questionnaire consisted of a demographic section with close ended answer type questions, while all other sections used Likert scale questions.

Responses were measured using a five-point Likert scale ranging from 1 to 5, where

1 = Strongly Disagree,

2 = Disagree,

3 = Neutral,

4 = Agree, and

5 = Strongly Agree.

This structure allowed students to clearly express their opinions and experiences.

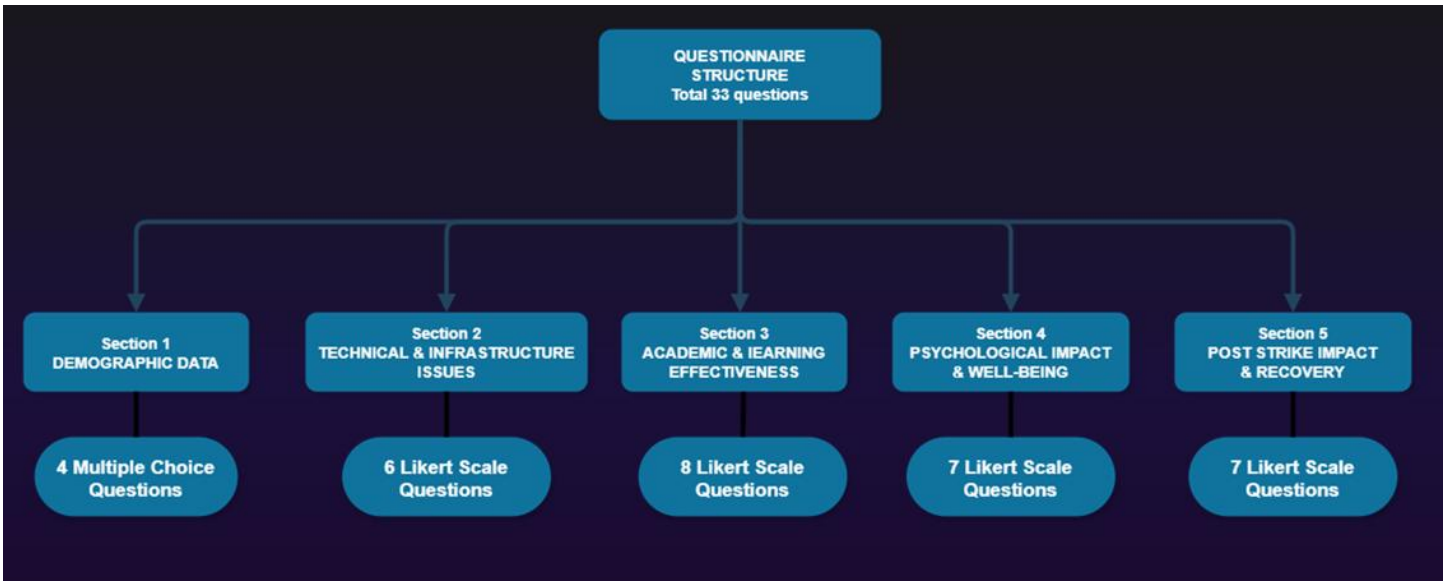


Figure 1: Questionnaire Design

2.2 Step-by-step methodology

The study was carried out through a series of systematic steps to ensure accuracy and reliability of the results.

- First, the research topic was selected by recognizing the need to study the effects of the 2024 non-academic staff strike on students in the Faculty of Science. Based on this, the objectives of the study were clearly defined.

- Next, the target population was identified as first-year and second-year undergraduate students in the Faculty of Science who were directly affected by the strike and were available during the data collection period.

- After identifying the target population, a structured questionnaire was developed to collect data related to academic, technical, and psychological impacts. A pilot study was conducted among group members as well as a small number of students from the target population to test the clarity and reliability of the questionnaire.

- The reliability of the initial questionnaire was evaluated using Cronbach's Alpha, which resulted in a value below 0.7, indicating low reliability. Based on this result and the feedback received, the questionnaire was redesigned and improved.

- The revised questionnaire was then distributed to the target population using online platforms for final data collection.

- Data were collected using an **online questionnaire created through Google Forms**. The survey link was distributed via:
  - ✓ University email system (Microsoft Outlook)
  - ✓ WhatsApp student groups and personal contacts

  This approach allowed efficient and quick data collection from a large number of students.

2.3 Theories and techniques

2.3.1. Sampling Technique

A stratified sampling technique with proportional allocation was used. First, the population was divided into two main strata based on academic year:

- ✓ first-year and
- ✓ second-year students.

Each academic year was further divided according to the degree programs in the Faculty of Science.

From each degree program, students were selected proportionally based on the registered student count. This method ensured fair representation of all degree programs and reduced sampling bias.

2.3.2. Sample Size Calculation

- Total population – 1884 students
- Required sample size:
  $n = [z^2pq + ME^2] / [ME^2 + (z^2pq/N)]$
  n = [(1.96^2 x 0.5 x 0.5) + 0.05^2]/ [0.05^2 + (1.96^2 x 0.5 x 0.5 /1884)]
  n = 0.9629 / 0.003009
  n ≈ 320 //

- Apply proportional allocation taking strata as year:

  Example Calculation (For Physical Science Degree Program):

  Total Students in year 1 = 272 Total Year 1 Students that need to represent a sample: (n/N) *np

  = (320/1884) *272
  = 46.1995
  ≈ 46 students //

Total Students in year 2 = 278 Total Year 2 Students that need to represent a sample: (n/N) *np = (320/1884) *278
= 47.2187
≈ 47 students //

N = Population Size
n = Sample Size
np = Total count of each Strata

Note: We proceeded with this method for each degree program

Table 1: Population Distribution of First- and Second-Year Students by Degree Program

Degree Program	Academic Year 2022/2023		Academic Year 2021/2022	
	Year I		Year II	
	Registered Count	Caculated Proportion	Registered Count	Caculated Proportion
Biological Science (BS)	188	32	195	33
Environmental Conservation Management (ENCM)	69	12	73	12
Management & Information Technology (MIT)	117	20	114	19
Physical Science (PS)	272	46	278	47
Physics & Electronics (PE)	60	10	56	10
Software Engineering (SE)	59	10	60	10
Sports Science (SS)	46	8	50	8
Applied Chemistry (AC)	45	8	52	9
Electronics & Computer Science (BECS)	75	13	75	13
Total	931	159	953	161

Table 2: Sampling Frame

EM		IM		SE		SS		PE		EC		BS		PS		AC	
EM/2022/091	EM/2021/032	IM/2022/060	IM/2021/051	SE/2022/001	SE/2021/055	SS/2022/007	SS/2021/020	PE/2022/009	PE/2021/031	EC/2022/016	EC/2021/011	BS/2022/213	BS/2021/016	PS/2022/131	PS/2021/244	AC/2022/012	AC/2021/003
EM/2022/010	EM/2021/082	IM/2022/065	IM/2021/073	SE/2022/021	SE/2021/047	SS/2022/050	SS/2021/011	PE/2022/005	PE/2021/047	EC/2022/078	EC/2021/043	BS/2022/241	BS/2021/181	PS/2022/214	PS/2021/060	AC/2022/001	AC/2021/021
EM/2022/047	EM/2021/054	IM/2021/074	IM/2021/015	SE/2022/031	SE/2021/029	SS/2022/025	SS/2021/047	PE/2022/006	PE/2021/025	EC/2022/024	EC/2021/005	BS/2022/086	BS/2021/009	PS/2022/186	PS/2021/156	AC/2022/033	AC/2021/011
EM/2022/053	EM/2021/073	IM/2022/040	IM/2021/002	SE/2022/053	SE/2021/017	SS/2022/023	SS/2021/009	PE/2022/027	PE/2021/050	EC/2022/071	EC/2021/049	BS/2022/063	BS/2021/075	PS/2022/117	PS/2021/152	AC/2022/003	AC/2021/046
EM/2022/083	EM/2021/075	IM/2021/041	IM/2021/110	SE/2022/045	SE/2021/002	SS/2022/042	SS/2021/014	PE/2022/045	PE/2021/049	EC/2022/053	EC/2021/067	BS/2022/209	BS/2021/228	PS/2022/028	PS/2021/185	AC/2022/040	AC/2021/002
EM/2022/001	EM/2021/022	IM/2022/048	IM/2021/068	SE/2022/015	SE/2021/022	SS/2022/034	SS/2021/012	PE/2022/024	PE/2021/054	EC/2022/026	EC/2021/052	BS/2022/163	BS/2021/114	PS/2022/033	PS/2021/192	AC/2022/032	AC/2021/054
EM/2022/076	EM/2021/015	IM/2022/126	IM/2021/093	SE/2022/011	SE/2021/039	SS/2022/046	SS/2021/049	PE/2022/058	PE/2021/038	EC/2022/006	EC/2021/035	BS/2022/224	BS/2021/024	PS/2022/146	PS/2021/181	AC/2022/014	AC/2021/048
EM/2022/087	EM/2021/059	IM/2021/124	IM/2021/120	SE/2022/002	SE/2021/025	SS/2022/038	SS/2021/045	PE/2022/021	PE/2021/008	EC/2022/075	EC/2021/033	BS/2022/046	BS/2021/214	PS/2022/322	PS/2021/118	AC/2022/009	AC/2021/044
EM/2022/038	EM/2021/049	IM/2021/070	IM/2021/050	SE/2022/010	SE/2021/007			PE/2022/028	PE/2021/055	EC/2022/069	EC/2021/060	BS/2022/222	BS/2021/160	PS/2022/017	PS/2021/272		AC/2021/012
EM/2022/098	EM/2021/003	IM/2022/031	IM/2021/025	SE/2022/059	SE/2021/019			PE/2022/041	PE/2021/002	EC/2022/004	EC/2021/046	BS/2022/211	BS/2021/133	PS/2022/157	PS/2021/136		
EM/2022/052	EM/2021/072	IM/2022/114	IM/2021/072							EC/2022/050	EC/2021/014	BS/2022/177	BS/2021/200	PS/2022/206	PS/2021/204		
EM/2022/020	EM/2021/058	IM/2021/044	IM/2021/026							EC/2022/005	EC/2021/024	BS/2022/027	BS/2021/066	PS/2022/345	PS/2021/278		
		IM/2021/039	IM/2021/099							EC/2022/034	EC/2021/012	BS/2022/260	BS/2021/107	PS/2022/064	PS/2021/043		
		IM/2021/012	IM/2021/097									BS/2022/185	BS/2021/155	PS/2022/325	PS/2021/027		
		IM/2022/104	IM/2021/118									BS/2022/094	BS/2021/001	PS/2022/221	PS/2021/290		
		IM/2021/059	IM/2021/067									BS/2022/150	BS/2021/048	PS/2022/344	PS/2021/012		
		IM/2022/062	IM/2021/114									BS/2022/217	BS/2021/140	PS/2022/321	PS/2021/180		
		IM/2021/051	IM/2021/076									BS/2022/186	BS/2021/208	PS/2022/265	PS/2021/098		
		IM/2022/041	IM/2021/059									BS/2022/210	BS/2021/219	PS/2022/115	PS/2021/170		
		IM/2022/125										BS/2022/069	BS/2021/174	PS/2021/324	PS/2021/270		
												BS/2022/230	BS/2021/218	PS/2022/091	PS/2021/229		
												BS/2022/234	BS/2021/223	PS/2022/247	PS/2021/139		
												BS/2022/214	BS/2021/148	PS/2022/286	PS/2021/032		
												BS/2022/178	BS/2021/014	PS/2022/019	PS/2021/177		
												BS/2022/105	BS/2021/026	PS/2022/152	PS/2021/315		
												BS/2022/060	BS/2021/178	PS/2022/154	PS/2021/143		
												BS/2022/077	BS/2021/166	PS/2022/168	PS/2021/071		
												BS/2022/015	BS/2021/092	PS/2022/014	PS/2021/038		
												BS/2022/115	BS/2021/025	PS/2022/171	PS/2021/151		
												BS/2022/146	BS/2021/095	PS/2022/070	PS/2021/110		
												BS/2022/161	BS/2021/047	PS/2022/108	PS/2021/300		
												BS/2022/191	BS/2021/112	PS/2022/150	PS/2021/306		
													BS/2021/053	PS/2022/296	PS/2021/107		
														PS/2022/295	PS/2021/281		
														PS/2022/294	PS/2021/264		
														PS/2022/155	PS/2021/171		
														PS/2022/250	PS/2021/298		
														PS/2022/264	PS/2021/283		
														PS/2022/327	PS/2021/174		
														PS/2022/151	PS/2021/077		
														PS/2022/218	PS/2021/020		
														PS/2022/116	PS/2021/088		
														PS/2022/126	PS/2021/248		
														PS/2022/246	PS/2021/176		
														PS/2022/314	PS/2021/265		
														PS/2022/282	PS/2021/228		
															PS/2021/288		

3. Results & Discussion

3.1 findings/outcomes of the study with interpretations.

3.1.1Response Rate and Demographic Overview

A total of 320 students were targeted for this survey, and 280 completed responses were received, yielding a **response rate of 87.5%**.

This high response rate ensures that the findings are representative of the target population and reduces the likelihood of non-response bias.

- Academic Year

  - 1st Year: 66% (184 students)
  - 2nd Year: 34% (96 students)

- Gender

  - Female: 55% (153 students)
  - Male: 45% (127 students)

- Degree Program

  - Physical Science: 41% (114)
  - Biological Science: 10% (28)
  - Physics and Electronics: 9% (25)
  - ENCM: 8% (22)
  - MIT: 8% (22)
  - Software Engineering: 7% (20)
  - Applied Chemistry: 7% (20)
  - Sports Science: 5% (15)
  - ECS: 5% (14)

- Accommodation

  - Home: 59% (166)
  - Hostel: 30% (84)
  - Boarding**:** 11% (30)

3.1.2 Technical and Infrastructure Impact

- Key Outcomes

Device access received the highest agreement at 88%, confirming most students were technologically equipped. **Learning materials access** followed with 66% agreement, indicating content distribution was effective. **Assignment submission** (59% agreement) and **LMS stability** (54% agreement) performed adequately for the majority. **Internet connectivity** received 47% agreement with 41% neutral, suggesting connectivity was functional but not exceptional. **Laboratory software installation** received the lowest agreement at 52%, with 38% neutral, revealing that practical courses need additional technological support.

- Interpretation

  Device access (88%) and learning materials access (66%) were clear strengths.
  Assignment submission (59%) and LMS stability (54%) performed adequately. Laboratory software installation (52%) was the weakest area, indicating practical courses need better support.
  Neutral responses (32-41%) across most aspects confirm systems were functional but the user experience was unexceptional.

Table 3: Summary of Most Common Responses for Technical Infrastructure Aspects

Aspect	**Most common Response Type**	**Percentage (%)**	**Number of Students**
Internet Connectivity	Neutral	41	115
Device Access	Agree	50	141
LMS Stability	Neutral	38	107
Assignment Submission	Agree	42	118
Lab Software Installation	Neutral	38	107
Learning Materials Access	Agree	50	139

Table 3: shows that most technical aspects were rated either **Neutral** or **Agree**. Device access and learning materials access were clear strengths, while internet connectivity and LMS stability were mostly rated neutral, indicating adequate but not fully reliable performance. Lab software installation also received neutral responses, suggesting some technical challenges.

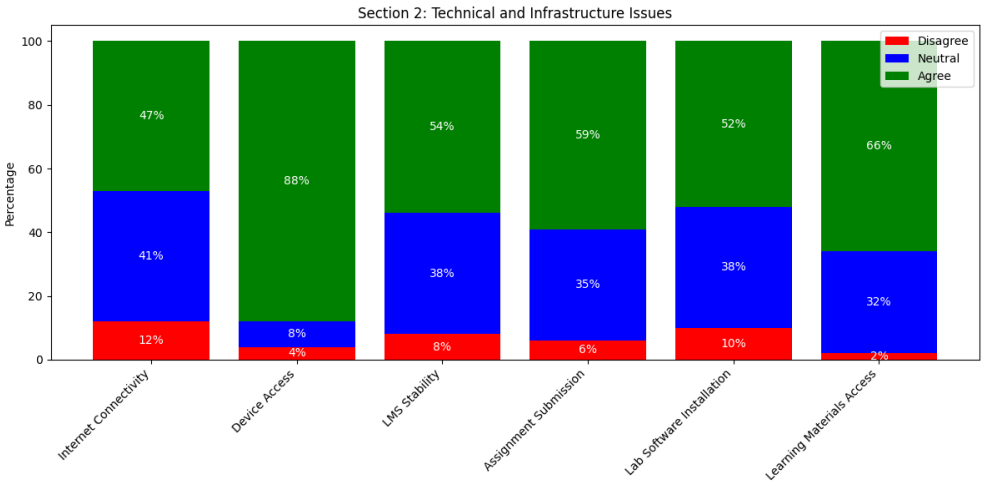


Figure 2: Summary of Agreement Levels for Technical Infrastructure (N=280)

The graph summarizes student agreement levels across six technical aspects. Device access and learning materials access emerged as strengths, while laboratory software installation showed the most need for improvement. Neutral responses dominated across connectivity, LMS stability, and software installation, indicating functional but unexceptional performance.

3.1.3 Academic Impact of the Strike

- Key Outcomes

Recorded lectures received the strongest positive response with 54% agreement, confirming their value as a flexible learning resource. **Home learning environments** were conducive for 49% of students, representing a relative strength. However, **concentration during online lectures** was a major concern, with only 24% able to maintain focus. **Interactivity** was limited, with only 35% experiencing adequate engagement. **Effectiveness of online lectures** received 32% agreement, while 44% remained neutral. **Confidence in catching up** was low at 32%, and only 25% felt **academically ready** for post-strike assessments. The **tight academic schedule** was manageable for only 24% of students.

- Interpretation

The teaching and learning experience were characterized by adequate content delivery but poor student engagement. Recorded lectures emerged as a clear strength and should become a permanent resource. However, only one in four students maintained concentration during online lectures, and only one-third feel confident they have caught up on missed learning. Low student confidence indicates that academic recovery extends beyond content delivery to include emotional reassurance and targeted support. Engagement and concentration challenges also call for improved online teaching methods.

Table 4: Student Perceptions of Teaching and Learning Experience During the Strike Period

Aspect	Disagree (%)	Neutral (%)	Agree (%)	Disagree (n)	Neutral (n)	Agree (n)
Online Lecture Effectiveness	24	44	32	67	123	90
Concentration During Lectures	35	41	24	98	115	67
Session Interactivity	22	43	35	61	120	99
Home Learning Environment	18	33	49	50	92	138
Recorded Lectures Helpful	14	32	54	40	90	150
Tight Academic Schedule	30	46	24	84	129	67
Confidence Catching Up	27	41	32	75	115	90
Academic Readiness	33	42	25	93	118	69

Table 4: This table presents percentage and frequency distributions (N= 280) of student responses across key teaching and learning aspects during the strike period, categorized as Disagree, Neutral, and Agree. The results highlight variation in engagement, concentration, and academic readiness during online learning.

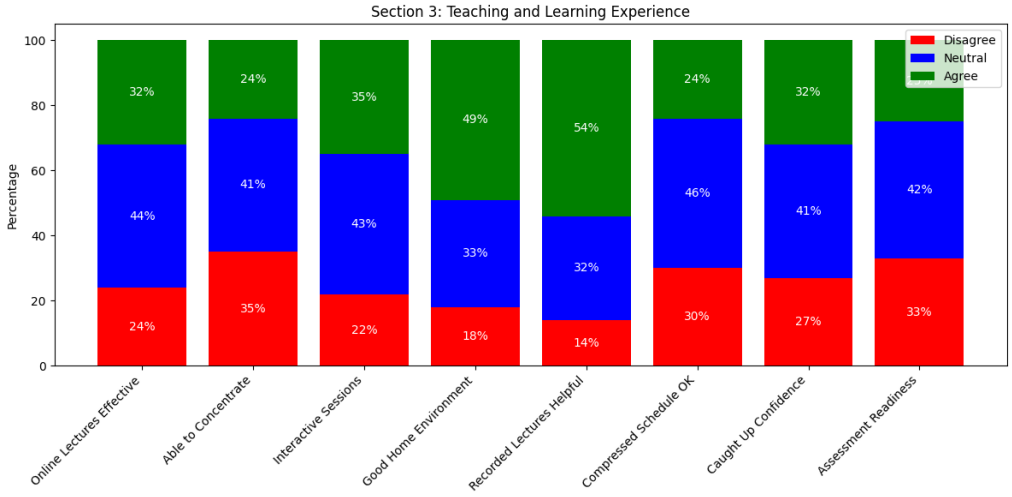


Figure 3: Student Perceptions of Teaching and Learning Experience

The graph shows that recorded lectures and home learning environments were relative strengths. However, concentration during online lectures and assessment readiness were major concerns. Only one-third of students felt confident in catching up on missed learning.

3.1.4 Psychological Impact and Student Well-being

- Key Outcomes

Disconnection from university community affected 65% of students, representing the strongest finding. **Sleep disruption** was reported by 56%, and **loneliness** by 55%. **Uncertainty about the start date** stressed 58%, while **academic future uncertainty** affected 52%. **General anxiety** increased for 39%, and **frustration interfering with daily life** affected 46% of students.

- Interpretation

The strike imposed significant psychological burdens beyond academic challenges. Disconnection (65%), sleep disruption (56%), and loneliness (55%) were the most pronounced concerns. Academic uncertainty affected over half of students, indicating clear communication could mitigate anxiety. Nearly half experienced frustration interfering with daily life, confirming emotional distress had practical consequences. These findings point to the need for enhanced mental health support, community-building during remote periods, and transparent communication during future disruptions.

Table 5: Psychological and Emotional Well-being of Students During the Strike

Aspect	Disagree (%)	Neutral (%)	Agree (%)	Disagree (n)	Neutral (n)	Agree (n)
Higher Anxiety	7	54	39	20	151	109
Loneliness / Social Isolation	9	36	55	25	101	154
Sleep Disruption	10	34	56	28	95	157
Disconnection from University Community	4	31	65	11	87	182
Academic Uncertainty	6	42	52	17	118	145
Uncertainty About Start Date	10	32	58	28	90	162
Frustration Affecting Daily Life	8	46	46	22	129	129

Table 5: This table presents percentage and frequency distributions (N = 280) of student responses on psychological and emotional well-being during the strike period, categorized as Disagree, Neutral, and Agree. The results reflect levels of anxiety, isolation, sleep disruption, and academic uncertainty experienced by students.

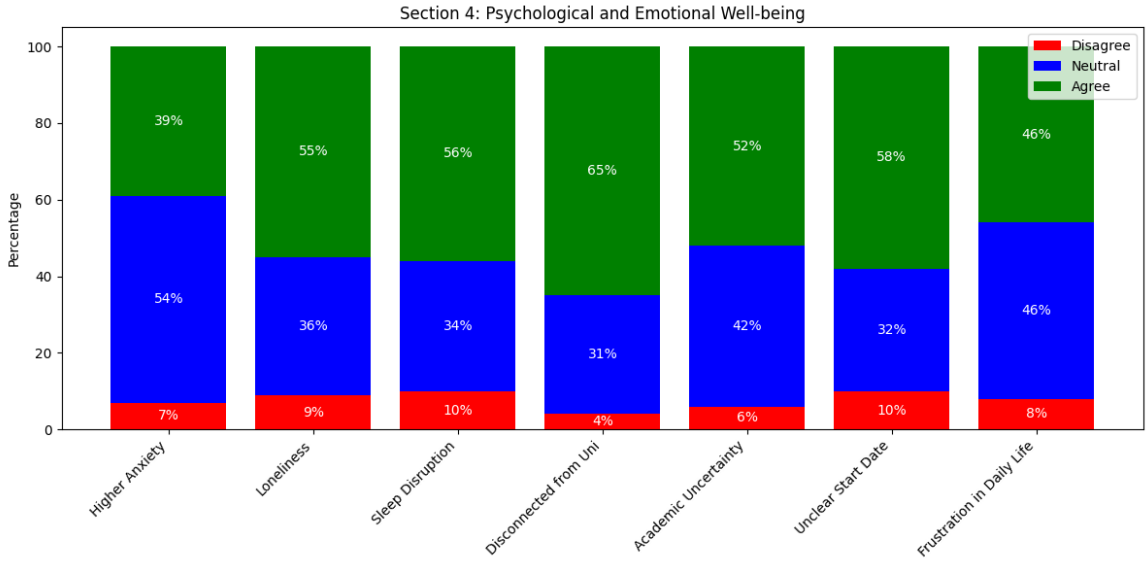


Figure 4: Psychological and Emotional Well-being During the Strike

The table reveals that disconnection from the university community was the most pronounced concern, followed by sleep disruption and loneliness. Academic uncertainty affected over half of students, while nearly half experienced frustration interfering with daily life.

3.1.5 Post-Strike Academic Recovery

- Key Outcomes

Stress from accelerated academic calendar affected 64% of students, the strongest finding. **Scheduling conflicts** with work and transportation affected 59%. Only **34% had adequate exam preparation time**, and only **31% found the transition gap sufficient**. **Financial savings** were reported by 45%. **Guidance on missed coursework** was received by 51%, and **administrative services** were functional for 50%.

- Interpretation

The accelerated calendar increased stress for 64% of students, and 59% experienced conflicts with work and transportation. Only 34% had adequate exam preparation time, and only 31% found the transition gap sufficient. While 51% received adequate guidance and 50% found administrative services functional, the recovery period imposed considerable burdens on student well-being. Future recovery planning must balance academic coverage with students' external commitments and provide adequate preparation time.

Table 6: Post-Strike Impact and Academic Recovery

Aspect	Disagree (%)	Neutral (%)	Agree (%)
Financial Savings During Strike	3	48	45
Stress from Accelerated Academic Calendar	4	32	64
Scheduling Conflicts with Work / Transport	4	37	59
Guidance on Missed Coursework & Labs	3	44	51
Administrative Services Functional	3	46	50
Adequate Exam Preparation Time	9	45	34
Sufficient Gap Before Lectures Resumed	6	55	31

Table 6: This table presents percentage distributions (N = 280) of student responses on post-strike impacts and recovery experiences, categorized as Disagree, Neutral, and Agree. The results highlight stress related to the accelerated academic calendar, scheduling conflicts, and perceptions of exam preparation time and institutional support.

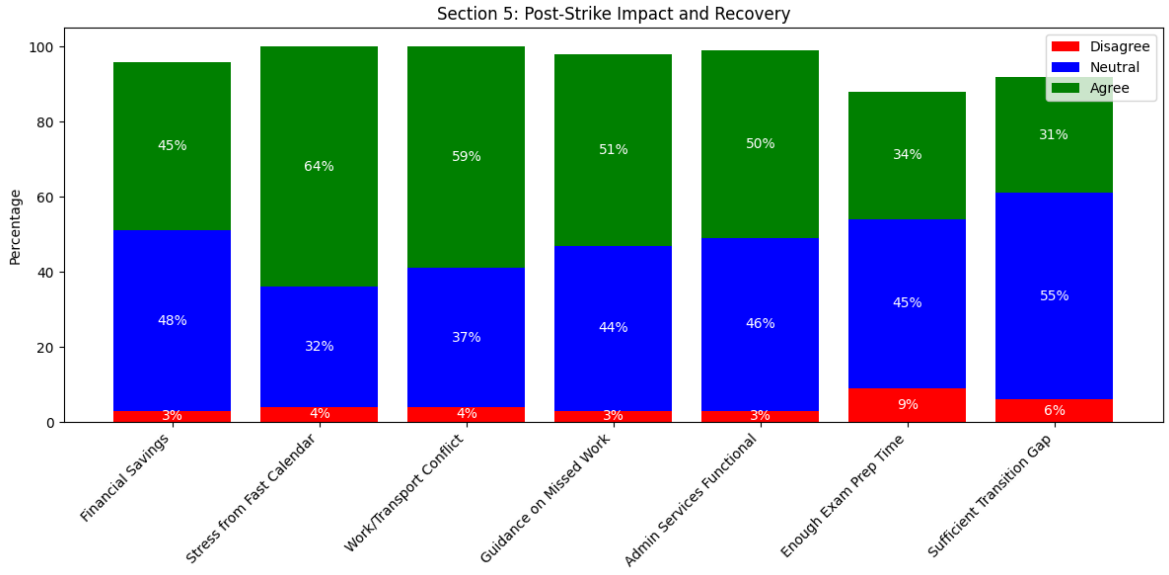


Figure 5: Post-Strike Recovery and Academic Transition

The table indicates that stress from the accelerated calendar and scheduling conflicts with work were the most significant challenges. Only one-third of students had adequate exam preparation time, and less than one-third found the transition gap sufficient. Guidance and administrative services were adequate for about half of students.

3.2 General Discussion

The university maintained academic continuity, but students faced academic and emotional challenges. Technical systems functioned adequately, though not optimally, with laboratory support needing improvement.

Recorded lectures were a strength, but low engagement and confidence in catching up indicate learning gaps. Many students experienced stress, loneliness, and disconnection.

The accelerated recovery schedule increased pressure, particularly regarding exam preparation and scheduling. Overall, a more student-centered approach is needed for future disruptions.

3.3 Discussion of Results in Relation to the Study Objectives

1. Identifying the most affected academic year
Both years faced challenges, but **first-years were more vulnerable** due to lower confidence, academic uncertainty, and higher stress**.**

2. Examining the academic impact of the strike
Academic continuity was maintained, but learning effectiveness suffered. Few felt confident catching up, concentration was low, and exam preparation time was inadequate.

3. Analyzing psychological and emotional effects
Significant strain was evident: 65% felt disconnected, 56% had sleep disruption, 55% experienced loneliness, and over half faced academic uncertainty.

4. Assessing experiences with online learning
Online learning was moderately effective. Recorded lectures and material access were strengths, but engagement, concentration, and lab software installation were problematic.

5. Providing suggestions to reduce future impacts
Findings recommend better communication, realistic timelines, mental health support, improved online engagement, and technical support for practical courses.

6. Analyzing positive outcomes of the strike
Positive aspects included adaptation to online platforms, value of recorded lectures, financial savings, and development of digital skills.

- Overall
  The results address all objectives, confirming academic and emotional impacts while highlighting resilience and opportunities for improvement.

3.4 Limitations of the Study

This study has several limitations that should be considered when interpreting the results.

- ✓ First, the study was limited to students from the Faculty of Science, and therefore the findings may not fully represent the experiences of students from other faculties of the university.

- ✓ Second, the data were collected using self-reported responses, which may be influenced by personal opinions, memory errors, or response bias. As a result, some responses may not accurately reflect actual experiences.

- ✓ Finally, at the time of the non-academic staff strike in 2024, there were four student batches in the university. However, during the period of data collection, only two batches (first-year and second-year students) were available on campus. Students from completed batches were not contactable and could not be included in the survey. This may have limited the completeness of the overall impact assessment.

3.5 Suggested Solutions and Recommendations for Future Strikes

- Strengthen Technical Infrastructure:
  Improve LMS stability and provide virtual labs with dedicated IT support for software access.
- Boost Online Engagement:
  Make recorded lectures permanent. Use shorter, interactive sessions (polls/quizzes) and train staff in online teaching.
- Prioritize Mental Health:
  Offer online counseling, peer support groups, and virtual social activities to combat loneliness and stress.
- Improve Communication:
  Reduce anxiety by providing clear, timely updates about academic schedules, even if information is pending.
- Plan Realistic Academic Recovery:
  Avoid accelerated calendars. Allow adequate gaps between assessments and offer flexible deadlines and revision weeks.
- Build a Formal Response Plan:
  Create a university-wide framework for managing future disruptions, covering online learning, support, and recovery protocols.

3.6 Conclusion

This study examined the overall impact of the 2024 non-academic staff strike on first-year and second-year students in the Faculty of Science, University of Kelaniya. The findings show that although most students had access to basic technical resources, their academic progress and psychological well-being were significantly affected. Recorded lectures were helpful, but live online sessions were less effective due to low interaction and concentration difficulties. Many students experienced increased stress, anxiety, loneliness, and uncertainty during the strike. First-year students were identified as the most affected group due to their limited university experience and difficulty adapting to online learning.

4 Reference Material

4.1 References

- University of Kelaniya. (2025). *Local students' enrolment (total number of students) in internal undergraduate degree programs – 2025 (as of 30th June 2025)*. Centre for Strategic Planning & University Statistics.
- IBM Corp. (2023). *IBM SPSS Statistics for Windows (Version 31.0.1.0) [Computer software]*. IBM Corp. https://www.ibm.com/products/spss-statistics

4.2 Appendices

- **Appendix 1:**
  Survey Questionnaire

5. Individual Contribution

PS/2022/080 – J N Gunasekara Served as the group leader and coordinated all project activities. Took major responsibility for topic selection, study design, and overall planning. Led the questionnaire design, supervised data collection, and guided the group during analysis. Played a key role in SPSS data analysis, interpretation of results, and final editing and compilation of the report.

PS/2022/087 – A A D T Dimalsha Played a key role in the successful completion of the group project. Made major contributions to methodology development, sampling technique, and sample size determination. Took primary responsibility for conducting the reliability analysis using SPSS (Cronbach's Alpha) and guided the redesign of the questionnaire after the pilot study. Also contributed significantly to data analysis, interpretation of results, and writing the Results and Discussion sections, as well as formatting tables and figures.

PS/2022/092 – R M N C Rathnayake Contributed to questionnaire preparation, pilot study support, and data collection. Assisted in organizing raw data and preparing summary tables for analysis.

PS/2022/162 – A J Imana Assisted in data collection, data coding, and preliminary analysis. Contributed to writing parts of the Results section and supported proofreading activities.

PS/2022/117 – S A D D Y Dissanayake Participated in data collection and actively contributed to the oral presentation of the project, helping to explain key findings and discussion points.

PS/2022/111 – M G C Sansiluni Contributed to the group presentation, assisting in explaining the background, objectives, and conclusions. Also supported reference formatting and final document review.

PS/2022/046 – N M T Madhuwantha Assisted in data entry, validation of responses, and preparation of appendices. Helped organize survey results.

PS/2022/219 – K A C K Kulathunga Supported questionnaire testing, response collection, and preparation of descriptive statistical summaries. Assisted in discussion of findings.

PS/2022/070 – A M A D M Alagiyawannna Actively participated in the oral presentation of the group project, contributing to the explanation of methodology and results.

PS/2022/074 – C N A Athukorala Played an important role in presentation preparation and graphical visualization. Designed charts, graphs, and visual summaries used in the process presentation.

PS/2022/199 – L A P Prabodhitha Contributed to survey administration, data entry, and preliminary interpretation of responses. Assisted in preparing the conclusion section.